> their livelihood, interact with each other and get involved in disputes and conflicts. District is the meeting point between state and citizens and ought to be the most important unit in State hierarchy. Over the last forty years the District departments have gradually decayed due to under-strength operational departments, shortage of funds, centralizing placement and decision-making, inter alia. (NACTA 2018, p. 10)

Despite such an acknowledgement, this chapter illustrates the lack of confidence of young people in the state structure. It describes the nature of the social contract today, where citizens can no longer be appeased through such documents, jaded as they are by their experience of the state's failure to meet its responsibilities in the past.

The 'social contract' in Pakistan

> *Every man for himself. All of us are like that. In Pakistan only poor people, people at the bottom are punished, if you are higher up no sense of accountability. It is different in other countries like Japan. There is accountability.*
>
> (Focus Group, Private University[10])

Pakistan was never a welfare state, but due to its colonial roots and inheriting a British legal framework, the basis for a Western-style social contract was laid. The question that arises is whether a Western-style social contract system remains the appropriate model for Pakistan today – or, in other words, are Western political scientists and social contract theorists such as Hobbes, Rousseau and Rawls perceived to be relevant for Pakistan, by the Pakistanis themselves (Siddiqi 2013)?

Social contract theories tried to establish why citizens would and should accept authoritative governments and obey the law, laying the foundation for the contemporary understanding of the modern state. Today, however, social contract theories take the existence of the modern state as a given. Rawls is at the basis of the welfare state making the social contract a platform for the construction of rights and responsibilities. His interpretation, however, also requires a certain amount of agency on the part of the individual – citizens have to take part or be able to take part in public life. The contract rests on reciprocity and both sides have to take part for it to work. This reciprocity is also at the basis of the legitimacy of the modern state. The state has to justify